ESC194: Calculus I
Exam Review

Brendan Tang

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1 Limits and Continuity

1.1 The Precise Definition of a Limit

The precise definition of a limit is as follows.

Definition. If $\forall \epsilon > 0$, $\exists \delta > 0$ such that $|x - a| < \delta \implies |f(x) - L| < \epsilon$, then

$$\lim_{x \to a} f(x) = L.$$

For one-sided limits, x is only approaching a from one side. Thus, we define the left-handed limit as follows.

Definition. If $\forall \epsilon > 0$, $\exists \delta > 0$ such that $a - \delta < x < a \implies |f(x) - L| < \epsilon$, then

$$\lim_{x \to a^-} f(x) = L.$$

As a number becomes arbitrarily large, it eventually surpasses every real number. Thus, we define limits to or approaching infinity as follows.

Definition. If $\forall M > 0$, $\exists \delta > 0$ such that $0 < |x - a| < \delta \implies f(x) > M$, then

$$\lim_{x \to a} f(x) \to \infty.$$

Conversely, if $\forall \epsilon > 0$, $\exists M > 0$ such that $x > M \implies |f(x) - L| < \epsilon$, then

$$\lim_{x \to \infty} f(x) = L.$$

Question. *How can we rigorously define right-handed and negative infinite limits? What about limits involving both concepts?*

Here are the general steps to a rigorous proof.

1. Given $\epsilon > 0$, find $\delta > 0$. Start with $|f(x) - L| < \epsilon$ and manipulate it into the form $|x - a| < \delta_0$. This step may require bounding $\delta \leq n$.
2. *Proof.* Given ϵ, let $\delta = min(n, \delta_0)$. Then, show that $|x - a| < \delta \implies |f(x) - L| < \epsilon$, as desired. □

1.2 Limit Theorems

Here are some important limit theorems.

Theorem 1.1. *If* $\lim_{x \to a} f(x)$ *and* $\lim_{x \to a} g(x)$ *exist, then*

- *(Constant LT)* $\lim_{x \to a} c = c$
- *(Sum LT)* $\lim_{x \to a}[f(x) + g(x)] = \lim_{x \to a} f(x) + \lim_{x \to a} g(x)$
- *(Product LT)* $\lim_{x \to a}[f(x) \cdot g(x)] = \lim_{x \to a} f(x) \cdot \lim_{x \to a} g(x)$
- *(Constant multiple LT)* $\lim_{x \to a} cf(x) = c \lim_{x \to a} f(x)$
- *(Power LT)* $\lim_{x \to a}[f(x)]^n = [\lim_{x \to a} f(x)]^n$
- *(Root LT)* $\lim_{x \to a} \sqrt[n]{f(x)} = \sqrt[n]{\lim_{x \to a} f(x)}$

Theorem 1.2 (Direct Substitution)**.** *If f is continuous at a, then*

$$\lim_{x\to a} f(x) = a.$$

The following theorem is often used to evaluate trigonometric limits.

Theorem 1.3 (Squeeze Theorem)**.** *If $g(x) < f(x) < h(x)$ and $\lim_{x\to a} g(x) = \lim_{x\to a} h(x) = L$, then*

$$\lim_{x\to a} f(x) = L.$$

When solving difficult trigonometric limits, it may help to find $\frac{\sin x}{x}$ terms.

1.3 Continuity Theorems

Here is the definition for continuity.

Definition. f is continuous at a point a if $\lim_{x\to a} f(x) = f(a)$.

Question. *How can we define continuity from the side? What about continuity on an open or closed interval?*

Here are some continuity theorems.

Theorem 1.4. *If f and g are continuous at a, then*

$$f + g,\ fg,\ cf$$

are also continuous at a.

Theorem 1.5. *The following types of functions are continuous on their domains*

- *polynomial*
- *rational*
- *root*
- *exponential*
- *logarithmic*
- *trigonometric*

Remark. It turns out that all elementary functions are continuous on their domains (why?).

2 Derivatives

2.1 Derivative Theorems

We begin with some important definitions.

Definition. The derivative of f is defined as

$$f'(x) \coloneqq \lim_{h \to 0} \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}.$$

f is differentiable at a point a if $f'(a)$ exists.

Question. *How can we define differentiability from the side? What about differentiability on an open or closed interval?*

From the definition of the derivative, we see that differentiability at a requires $\lim_{h \to 0}[f(a+h) - f(a)] = 0$ (why?). This implies that f is continuous at a. Thus, we arrive at the following theorem.

Theorem 2.1. *If f is differentiable at a, then f is continuous at a.*

Be careful, as this theorem does not hold for the converse. That is, continuity at a does not imply differentiability at a.

Here are some useful differentiation theorems.

Theorem 2.2. *If f' exists, then*

- *(Constant DT)* $f(x) = c \implies f'(x) = 0$
- *(Sum DT)* $(f+g)' = f' + g'$
- *(Product DT)* $(fg)' = f'g + fg'$
- *(Reciprocal DT)* $\left(\frac{1}{f}\right)' = -\frac{f'}{f^2}$
- *(Quotient DT)* $\left(\frac{f}{g}\right)' = \frac{f'g - fg'}{g^2}$
- *(Power DT)* $f(x) = x^n \implies f'(x) = nx^{n-1}$
- *(Chain rule)* $(f \circ g)' = (f' \circ g) \cdot g'$

2.1.1 Existence Theorems

These theorems are very important, serving as stepping stones for many proofs that will be encountered in this course. While their proofs will not be provided here, it is highly encouraged to find and read through them yourself.

Theorem 2.3 (Intermediate Value Theorem)**.** *If $f\colon [a,b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is continuous, then for every $N \in \big(f(a), f(b)\big)$, there exists $c \in (a,b)$ such that $f(c) = N$.*

Theorem 2.4 (Extreme Value Theorem)**.** *If $f\colon [a,b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is continuous, then there exists $c, d \in [a,b]$ such that f attains an absolute maximum value $f(c)$ and an absolute minimum value $f(d)$.*

Theorem 2.5 (Mean Value Theorem)**.** *If $f\colon [a,b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is continuous and differentiable on (a,b), there exists $c \in (a,b)$ such that*

$$f'(c) = \frac{f(b) - f(a)}{b - a}.$$

By using Theorem 2.5 with $f(a) = f(b)$, we get a special case.

Theorem 2.6 (Rolle's Theorem)**.** *If $f\colon [a,b] \to \mathbb{R}$ is continuous, differentiable on (a,b), and $f(a) = f(b)$, there exists $c \in (a,b)$ such that $f'(c) = 0$.*

Remark. Although Theorem 2.6 is presented here as a special case of Theorem 2.5, chronologically the reverse is true. In fact, Theorem 2.6 is the core tool used to prove Theorem 2.5, which serves as its generalization.

2.1.2 Interlude (Approximation)

On a bit of an unrelated note, we can use differentials to approximate a function f by the formula

$$f(x + \Delta x) \approx f(x) + f'(x)\Delta x.$$

This has been included for the sake of completeness, as it has been tested before.

2.2 Curve Sketching

By Fermat's theorem on stationary points, we arrive at the following definition.

Definition. $\big(c, f(c)\big)$ is a critical point on f if $f'(c) = 0$ or $f'(c)$ does not exist.

Here are the general steps to curve sketching.

1. From f:
    - Find the domain and range
    - Find the x and y intercepts
    - Find any endpoints or removable discontinuities, if they exist
    - Find any asymptotes and their behaviour, if they exist
    - Determine if f has any symmetry
    - Determine the end behaviour of f
2. From f':
    - Find all critical points on f
    - Determine the intervals of increase/decrease
    - Find vertical tangents or cusps, if they exist
3. From f'':
    - Find local maxima/minima and any inflection points, if they exist
    - Determine the intervals of concavity

2.3 Applications of Derivatives

One application of derivatives is related rates. Related rates are problems where two or more quantities change, but are still linked by an equation. To solve a related rates problem, find an equation that directly relates the variables and apply the chain rule.

Another application of derivatives is optimization. To solve an optimization problem, reduce the problem to an equation in one variable, then evaluate at endpoints and critical points.

3 Integrals

3.1 Summation